

ABC Company

Pricing & Quotation Guide

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1. Introduction & Pricing Philosophy

ABC Company believes that pricing transparency is not a courtesy — it is a prerequisite for a healthy client engagement. Before a single line of code is written, every client receives a detailed written estimate that breaks down scope, team composition, timeline, and the assumptions underlying each cost line. There are no hidden costs and no surprise invoices. If the project requires a third-party SaaS licence, a specialist consultant, or an expedited deployment window, that cost is surfaced in the proposal before signature. ABC Company's goal is for clients to walk away from every invoice nodding in recognition, not squinting in confusion.

ABC Company's pricing occupies a deliberate position in the market: above the low-cost offshore commodity tier where quality and communication are sacrificed for the lowest possible day-rate, and below the premium Western agency tier where significant overhead is baked into every hour. Clients who choose ABC Company receive senior engineering talent, direct communication with the developers doing the work, and a delivery culture shaped by nine years of product-minded practice — at rates that are typically 30 to 40 percent below comparable US or UK agencies. This positioning is sustainable because of ABC Company's Colombo cost base, its low management overhead, and its disciplined approach to team sizing.

ABC Company employs value-based pricing principles wherever the scope permits. For well-defined product work, the estimate reflects the value the software will create for the client's business — not merely the number of engineer-hours expected to be consumed. A module that automates a manual workflow saving forty hours per week is priced on the basis of that impact, not solely on the basis of the two-week implementation sprint required to build it. In practice this means that unusually high-value integrations or revenue-critical launch features may sit at the higher end of the applicable rate range, while straightforward CRUD work or internal tooling will sit at the lower end.

Estimation methodology at ABC Company is bottom-up: the technical lead decomposes the scope into individual user stories, assigns story-point complexity ratings based on historical velocity data from comparable past projects, and then converts those points into an hour range using the team's tracked delivery rate. Every estimate carries a 15 to 20 percent contingency buffer to absorb unknowns — undocumented dependencies, integration edge cases, security review findings, and the inevitable clarifications that emerge as design moves to implementation. Critically, under a Time and Materials engagement the buffer is only invoiced if it is consumed; if the project delivers cleanly within the base estimate, the client is not charged for contingency hours. Under a Fixed Price engagement, unused buffer time is returned to the client as schedule credit for post-launch support.

2. Hourly Rate Card

The table below sets out ABC Company’s current standard hourly rates by role and seniority band, together with the monthly equivalent cost at 160 billable hours per month. All rates are quoted in US dollars and are exclusive of any applicable taxes or third-party costs.

Role	Hourly Rate (USD)	Monthly Equivalent (160 hrs)
Junior Engineer	\$35–\$50 / hr	\$5,600–\$8,000
Mid-Level Engineer	\$50–\$75 / hr	\$8,000–\$12,000
Senior Engineer	\$75–\$110 / hr	\$12,000–\$17,600
Tech Lead / Architect	\$110–\$150 / hr	\$17,600–\$24,000
ML / AI Engineer	\$90–\$140 / hr	\$14,400–\$22,400
DevOps Engineer	\$70–\$110 / hr	\$11,200–\$17,600
UI/UX Designer	\$55–\$85 / hr	\$8,800–\$13,600
Project Manager	\$60–\$90 / hr	\$9,600–\$14,400
QA Engineer	\$40–\$65 / hr	\$6,400–\$10,400
CTO Advisory / Consulting	\$150–\$200 / hr	\$24,000–\$32,000

The rates above represent the current standard published rates for individual roles within ABC Company’s delivery team. The range within each role reflects the variability introduced by project complexity, timeline urgency, and the specific seniority level required within the band. A senior engineer working on a greenfield cloud-native platform with strict performance SLAs will be positioned toward \$110/hr; the same title assigned to a stable maintenance engagement with well-understood scope will fall closer to \$75/hr. Clients are always informed in advance where a given project lands within the range and why.

Real-world engagements almost never involve a single role billed at a single rate. A typical growth-phase project might include one senior engineer, two mid-level engineers, a QA engineer, a part-time designer, and a project manager. When the hours for each role are blended into a single effective rate, most projects land between \$65 and \$90 per hour — a figure that is useful for initial budget-sizing conversations before full scoping is complete. ABC Company provides a blended-rate estimate in every proposal alongside the per-role breakdown so clients can cross-check the arithmetic themselves.

For clients accustomed to US or UK agency pricing, a direct market comparison is instructive. Mid-to-senior software engineers at London or New York digital agencies typically bill between \$150 and \$250 per hour once agency overhead, account management, and office costs are absorbed into the rate. ABC Company’s equivalent roles are priced 30 to 40 percent below that range without compromise to output quality, communication standards, or team seniority. The company achieves this through a Colombo operational base that carries significantly lower infrastructure cost than Western city offices, combined with a flat organisational structure that keeps non-billable management overhead minimal.

3. Project Package Tiers

ABC Company organises project engagements into three budget tiers. Each tier defines a scope of work, a typical team composition, a duration range, and a specific set of deliverables. The tier boundaries are indicative rather than rigid — a project that starts as a Starter engagement can be expanded into a Growth engagement if requirements evolve during discovery.

Starter Package — \$15,000–\$45,000

Duration: 1–3 months | Team: 1–2 developers, 1 part-time designer, 1 part-time QA

The Starter Package is designed for organisations — typically early-stage startups, internal innovation teams, or SMEs — that need a focused, high-quality deliverable without committing to a multi-month programme of work. Engagements in this tier are characterised by a well-bounded scope, a small dedicated team, and a compressed timeline of one to three months. Requirements gathering is included in the package cost; ABC Company's product consultants work with the client in the first week to translate business goals into a prioritised feature list before any engineering resources are allocated.

Every Starter engagement includes UI/UX design (wireframes and high-fidelity mockups), full development to agreed specifications, basic automated quality assurance testing, deployment to both a staging environment and a production environment, full source code handover via a private repository, and a 30-day post-launch warranty period during which defect fixes are provided at no additional charge. Scope that falls outside the Starter tier — native mobile applications, complex multi-system integrations, ongoing maintenance retainers — is quoted separately and may elevate the engagement to the Growth tier.

Included	Requirements gathering, UI/UX design, development, basic QA, staging & production deployment, source code handover, 30-day warranty
Not Included	Ongoing maintenance, complex multi-system integrations, native mobile applications

Example Projects — Starter

Example Project	Typical Cost	Duration
Custom Landing Page	\$8,000–\$15,000	2–3 weeks
Admin Dashboard	\$15,000–\$25,000	4–6 weeks
Internal Tool	\$20,000–\$35,000	6–10 weeks
REST API Development	\$10,000–\$20,000	3–5 weeks

Growth Package — \$50,000–\$180,000

Duration: 3–6 months | Team: 3–6 people (lead, 2–3 developers, designer, QA)

The Growth Package serves companies that are building full commercial products, scaling existing platforms, or launching in new markets with meaningful technical ambition. Engagements in this tier typically span three to six months and involve a cross-functional team of three to six people combining a technical lead, mid-to-senior engineers, a designer, and a dedicated QA resource. The project manager is embedded in the team rather than a peripheral overhead function, attending sprint ceremonies, owning the risk register, and serving as the primary communication interface between ABC Company and the client's stakeholders.

In addition to everything included in the Starter Package, Growth engagements receive a comprehensive design system that standardises component behaviour across the product, a fully configured CI/CD pipeline enabling daily deployments, an automated regression test suite covering critical paths, environment-level performance optimisation, and a 60-day post-launch warranty. Technical documentation is produced throughout the engagement — not as a post-project afterthought — so that the client's own engineering team can onboard to the codebase with minimal friction after handover.

Included	Everything in Starter plus: design system, CI/CD pipeline, automated testing, performance optimisation, technical documentation, 60-day warranty
Not Included	Compliance certifications, disaster recovery planning, executive stakeholder reporting

Example Projects — Growth

Example Project	Typical Cost	Duration
Mobile App (iOS + Android)	\$40,000–\$80,000	3–5 months
E-Commerce Platform	\$50,000–\$100,000	3–5 months
SaaS Application	\$80,000–\$150,000	4–6 months
Data Dashboard / BI Tool	\$40,000–\$70,000	3–4 months

Enterprise Package — \$200,000–\$500,000+

Duration: 6–12+ months | Team: 6–12 people (architect, developers, DevOps, QA, PM, designer)

Enterprise engagements are complex, multi-phase programmes of work typically running six to twelve months or longer. They are characterised by multi-system integration requirements, regulated industry contexts (fintech, healthcare, insurance, government), platform migration scope, or requirements for compliance certification. Teams in this tier range from six to twelve people and almost always include a dedicated technical architect, a DevOps engineer, a dedicated project manager, and specialist QA resources with automation expertise.

Enterprise clients receive all deliverables from the Growth Package plus formal architecture documentation, a security audit conducted before launch, compliance certification support (HIPAA, PCI-DSS, SOC 2), load and stress testing to validate performance under peak traffic, disaster recovery planning, and a 90-day post-launch warranty. Weekly written stakeholder reports and monthly executive summaries are standard. A dedicated project manager owns the programme plan, the RAID log, and all stakeholder communication so that client-side leadership can remain focused on business priorities rather than project administration.

Included	Everything in Growth plus: architecture design, security audit, compliance certification support, load testing, disaster recovery planning, dedicated PM, weekly stakeholder reports, 90-day warranty
Not Included	Third-party audit fees, travel costs, post-warranty operational support (available as separate retainer)

Example Projects — Enterprise

Example Project	Typical Cost	Duration
Payment Platform	\$150,000–\$300,000	6–10 months
Healthcare Portal	\$120,000–\$250,000	6–9 months
Enterprise Integration Hub	\$100,000–\$200,000	5–8 months
Marketplace Platform	\$200,000–\$400,000	8–12 months

4. Sample Project Estimates

The estimates below are drawn from ABC Company’s project history and represent the typical cost and duration range for each project category. They are provided as a budgeting reference and are not binding quotations. A formal written proposal with a precise estimate is produced following a discovery call.

Project Type	Typical Range (USD)	Duration	Team Size	Key Variables
Landing Page / Marketing Site	\$8,000–\$15,000	2–4 weeks	1–2	Custom animations, CMS integration
Mobile App MVP (single platform)	\$25,000–\$50,000	2–3 months	2–3	Platform (iOS/Android), offline support
Mobile App (cross-platform)	\$40,000–\$80,000	3–5 months	3–5	Number of screens, API integrations
Full SaaS Platform	\$100,000–\$250,000	4–8 months	4–8	Multi-tenancy, billing, analytics
E-Commerce Platform	\$40,000–\$80,000	3–5 months	3–5	Payment gateways, inventory complexity
AI / ML Feature (chatbot, RAG)	\$15,000–\$35,000	4–8 weeks	2–3	Data volume, model complexity
Data Pipeline / ETL	\$20,000–\$60,000	4–12 weeks	2–3	Data sources, real-time vs batch
Cloud Migration	\$30,000–\$100,000	2–4 months	2–4	Current infrastructure, compliance
API Development	\$10,000–\$30,000	2–6 weeks	1–2	Number of endpoints, integrations
Design System	\$15,000–\$40,000	4–8 weeks	1–2	Component count, documentation depth

The ranges in the table above reflect projects that ABC Company has delivered in each category over the past four years. The lower bound of each range assumes a well-defined scope, established technology choices, no regulatory complexity, and a client team that is responsive and decisive during discovery and review cycles. Projects that meet all of these conditions routinely come in at or below the stated lower bound. The upper bound reflects engagements where scope is broader, technology choices are novel, integration partners are slow to provide sandbox access, or the client requires extensive rounds of design review and iteration.

Several factors reliably push estimates toward the upper end of any range. Real-time data requirements — whether for collaborative editing, live dashboards, or event-driven workflows — add infrastructure and engineering complexity that simple request-response architectures do not carry. Compliance obligations (HIPAA, PCI-DSS, GDPR) require additional security design, audit logging, and documentation work that can add 15 to 25 percent to the base estimate. Third-party integrations are another common cost driver: integrating with a well-documented public API typically costs two to four days of engineering work, but integrating with a legacy enterprise system that communicates via SFTP, SOAP, or undocumented internal protocols can cost three to four times that figure.

Conversely, several factors consistently reduce costs below the midpoint. Clients who bring a clear, written product specification with wireframes already validated by end users save significant discovery and design time. Choosing a proven, well-supported technology stack — React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS — rather than an experimental

framework reduces risk and lets ABC Company draw on its existing internal component libraries. Returning clients benefit from the fact that ABC Company already understands the codebase, the deployment environment, and the team's communication preferences, which eliminates the ramp-up cost embedded in every new-client estimate.

5. Engagement Models & Billing

ABC Company offers three engagement models. The right model depends on how well the scope is defined, how likely requirements are to evolve, and whether the client needs a one-time deliverable or sustained engineering capacity. All three models can be combined across different workstreams within a single client relationship.

Fixed Price

Best For	Well-defined scope with stable requirements
Payment Schedule	30% on signature / 40% at midpoint milestone / 30% on delivery
Payment Terms	Net-15 per invoice
Scope Changes	Handled via formal change request with written cost and timeline impact

Fixed Price engagements are best suited to projects with a clearly defined and stable scope. The client receives a total project cost before work begins and that cost does not change unless the scope changes. ABC Company bears the estimation risk: if the project takes more hours than estimated, ABC Company absorbs the difference; if the project delivers efficiently, the client pays the agreed price regardless. This model is popular with clients who have fixed budgets or who need to present a specific capital commitment to internal approvers before a project can be authorised.

Payment terms for Fixed Price engagements follow a three-stage milestone structure: 30 percent is due upon contract signature and project kick-off, 40 percent is due upon delivery and acceptance of the defined midpoint milestone (typically a functional prototype or integration-complete build), and the final 30 percent is due upon production launch and client acceptance. Invoices are issued at each milestone with net-15 payment terms. Scope changes after signature are handled through a formal change request process: ABC Company provides a written impact assessment covering the additional effort, cost, and timeline effect, and work on the change does not begin until the client signs the change order.

Time & Materials (T&M)

Best For	Evolving requirements, ongoing development, exploration work
Billing Cycle	Monthly invoices based on actual hours worked
Payment Terms	Net-15 per invoice
Reporting	Weekly time tracking report by role and task

Time and Materials (T&M) engagements are the most flexible model and are best suited to projects where requirements are expected to evolve — early-stage product discovery, platform modernisation programmes, or ongoing feature development after an initial launch. Under T&M, ABC Company bills only for actual hours worked at the agreed rates. Invoices are issued monthly and itemised by role and deliverable, with net-15 payment terms. Clients receive a weekly time tracking report showing hours logged per team member, tasks completed, and any flag items requiring client input.

T&M is also the default model for dedicated team engagements where the client manages priorities and backlog directly. Under this model the client retains full sprint-by-sprint control over what the team works on, can pause and

resume work with 30 days notice, and is never locked into a fixed scope that no longer reflects their evolving business reality. ABC Company recommends T&M to clients who have an in-house product manager or CTO who wants hands-on ownership of the development roadmap.

Dedicated Team

Best For	Long-term engagements of 3+ months; client-managed backlog
Billing	Fixed monthly retainer per team member
Minimum Commitment	3 months
Notice Period	30 days written notice to reduce team size or terminate

The Dedicated Team model is designed for clients who need sustained engineering capacity over a period of three months or more. Under this model the client pays a fixed monthly retainer per team member rather than tracking individual hours. The retainer covers the engineer's time, ABC Company's HR and operational infrastructure, tooling licences, and the project management overhead required to keep the team running smoothly. The client directs the team's work through their own backlog and sprint ceremonies; ABC Company owns the people infrastructure so the client does not have to.

The minimum commitment for a Dedicated Team engagement is three months, which reflects the time required to onboard team members to a codebase, establish working rhythms, and begin delivering meaningful throughput. After the initial three-month period the engagement continues on a rolling monthly basis with 30 days written notice required to reduce team size or terminate. Clients who commit to six or more months upfront are eligible for the long-term commitment discount described in Section 6.

6. Discount Schedule

The discounts below are available to qualifying clients and are applied to the base labour rate quoted in the proposal. Discounts must be claimed at the time of proposal and cannot be applied retroactively to work already invoiced.

Discount Type	Discount	Qualifying Conditions
Long-term commitment (6+ months)	5%	Signed contract for 6 or more consecutive months
Long-term commitment (12+ months)	10%	Signed contract for 12 or more consecutive months
Large team (5+ members)	5%	Five or more full-time equivalent team members
Returning client	5%	Client has successfully completed at least one prior project with ABC Company
Non-profit / Social Impact	15%	Verified registered non-profit or social enterprise organisation

Maximum Combined Discount	25% off applicable base labour rates
Applies To	ABC Company labour rates only
Does Not Apply To	Third-party costs, SaaS licences, travel, compliance audit fees

Discounts at ABC Company are structured to reward commitment, scale, and loyalty rather than applied arbitrarily in negotiation. Each discount type has a defined condition that must be verified before the discount is applied to a proposal. Long-term commitment discounts require a signed contract covering the full commitment period; partial-year engagements that are later extended do not retroactively qualify. The large-team discount applies from the first month of an engagement where five or more full-time equivalents are active simultaneously.

Discounts are combinable up to a maximum aggregate of 25 percent off the applicable base rate. For example, a returning non-profit client with a large team and a 12-month commitment would qualify for the returning client discount (5%), the non-profit discount (15%), the large team discount (5%), and the 12-month commitment discount (10%) — but the total applied discount would be capped at 25 percent regardless. Discounts apply to ABC Company's labour rates only. Third-party costs — cloud hosting, SaaS licences, app store developer accounts, premium fonts, or compliance audit fees — are passed through at cost and are not subject to any discount.

Non-profit and social impact organisations should include documentation of their registered charitable or social enterprise status with their initial enquiry. ABC Company reviews non-profit eligibility on a case-by-case basis and may apply discretionary additional support — including pro-bono advisory time — for organisations working in areas of particular social importance such as mental health, education access, or climate technology. These arrangements are agreed separately and are not governed by the standard discount schedule.

7. What’s Included vs. Extra

The table below summarises what is covered by the quoted project or retainer fee versus what is billed separately as a pass-through cost. This distinction is consistent across all engagement models and package tiers.

Included in All Engagements

- Project management and sprint coordination
- Slack and email communication with the delivery team
- Weekly written progress reports with status, risks, and next-week plan
- Peer code reviews and internal technical quality checks
- Basic CI/CD pipeline configuration (GitHub Actions or equivalent)
- Deployment to staging and production environments
- Full source code handover via private version control repository
- Post-launch warranty period (30, 60, or 90 days depending on tier)
- Technical documentation: API references, architecture diagrams, README files
- Onboarding support for the client's engineering team during handover

Billed Separately

- Third-party SaaS platform licences (AWS, GCP, Azure, Stripe, Twilio, etc.)
- Apple Developer and Google Play developer account fees
- Premium commercial fonts, icon libraries, or licensed stock assets
- Travel and accommodation expenses for on-site visits or workshops
- Rush and overtime work billed at 1.5x the applicable standard rate
- Formal compliance certifications: HIPAA, PCI-DSS, SOC 2 audit fees
- Legal review of custom contract terms or IP assignment agreements
- Post-warranty maintenance and support (available as a separate retainer)
- Translation and localisation services beyond English-language content
- User research recruitment and incentive costs for usability testing

ABC Company's goal is to ensure that clients know exactly what they are getting before they sign. Everything in the 'Included' column above is covered by the quoted project or retainer fee — no add-ons, no hidden line items at invoice time. Project management is not a separate cost-centre billed on top of engineering; it is embedded in the team and priced into the engagement. The post-launch warranty means that if a defect in the delivered code surfaces within the warranty window, it is fixed at ABC Company's cost, not the client's.

Items in the 'Billed Separately' column are outside ABC Company's direct control and are therefore quoted as pass-through costs at the exact amount invoiced to ABC Company, without markup. Clients are given advance notice and written confirmation before any third-party cost is incurred on their behalf. Rush work — defined as a request to deliver a defined scope in less than 60 percent of the standard estimated duration — is subject to the 1.5x overtime rate, and the client is informed of this uplift in writing before the accelerated schedule begins.

8. How to Get a Quote

Getting a project estimate from ABC Company is a straightforward, no-obligation process. The steps below describe what happens from initial contact to signed agreement, and what the client can expect at each stage.

1. Share Your Project Idea

Reach out by email, phone, or the contact form on the ABC Company website. A brief description of what you are building, the problem it solves, and a rough sense of timeline and budget is enough to get started. There is no requirement to have a polished brief at this stage.

2. Initial Response Within 24 Hours

A member of ABC Company's business development team will respond within one business day with acknowledgement of your enquiry and a short list of clarifying questions. These questions are designed to help the team form a realistic picture of scope before scheduling time with you.

3. Discovery Call (30–60 Minutes)

A brief video call with a senior engineer and, where relevant, a product consultant. The purpose of this call is to understand your requirements in enough depth to produce an accurate estimate. Calls are non-obligatory and free of charge.

4. Written Proposal Within 5 Business Days

Following the discovery call, ABC Company delivers a written proposal covering: detailed scope definition, proposed technology stack, team composition and seniority levels, project timeline with milestones, per-role rate breakdown, total cost estimate with contingency, and recommended engagement model. The proposal is a working document — clients are encouraged to ask questions and request revisions.

5. Proposal Validity and Next Steps

All proposals are valid for 30 days from the date of issue. If the client wishes to proceed, ABC Company issues a Statement of Work and Master Service Agreement for signature. Work begins once both documents are counter-signed and the initial payment (for Fixed Price) or first month's retainer (for Dedicated Team) is received.

Contact ABC Company

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